HIGH-PERFORMANCE TEAM · HOW TO PLAY

Seven weeks. Five days a week. Six features (A–F) to deliver before **week 7 closes**. You commit all five days *before* you know what is coming, resolve them together, then close the week. From week 2, Events crash into the plan you already made. Everything is **cooperative**: the five Activity cards are the **team's** - nobody plays one. Deliver everything with a Team Score above the upper line and you did not only finish the project, you built a team that could do it again.

SET UP · ABOUT FIFTEEN MINUTES

1. **Deal and build.** Each player is dealt five habitus parts at random - **Base, Legs, Torso, Head, Item** - and slots them into the seats on their person board (the **SPECIMEN**). Nobody chooses.
2. **Take your tiles.** The **NEED** tile that names your Torso and the **HERO** tile that names your Legs.
3. **Start square.** Mark one square on your **SKILLS** grid: where your **Head's row** (education) meets your **Item's column** (skill). Then put a tile on the same square of **THE ZONE** (stacked face up if two of you start on the same square).
4. **Pick a Project card**, turn **THE PROJECT** face up and seat it. It names features A–F. Read their cost, complexity and locks: **D** and **F** cannot be placed until what they sit on is built.
5. **Motivation 5** and **Capital 0** for everyone. Week marker on 1. Shuffle the Events, do not draw yet.
6. Every board starts on its **back**. Read **THE ZONE**'s back first: it is the introduction. When set-up is done, turn **THE ZONE** and **THE PROJECT** over. **SHIT HAPPENS** and **THE TEAM** stay on their backs; they turn over in week 2.

YOUR PERSON BOARD

- **Habitus seats** - who you are. Nothing is written down: the figure is the record.
- **Zone Start / SKILLS grid** - your own 5×5: education rows × skill columns. A counter in a square means you can do that. Item diamonds sit below the grid, Head hexagons beside it.
- **Hero** (under Legs) - once a game, cancel an Event that names your Pressure Response. +2 Capital to you, +1 Motivation to another. Needs 3 Motivation.
- **Need** (under Torso) - from week 2, +1 Motivation if your Torso's condition was met this week.
- **Flex** - the marker for a day you worked as Overtime and owe back.
- **Motivation** (5 squares, starts 5) and **Capital** (0–5, a marker you slide, only grows when the team witnesses it). **THE WEEK** checklist is printed down the side.

THE WEEK · SEVEN STEPS, EVERY WEEK

1. **PLAN** - lay **five** Activity cards, Monday to Friday. Nothing resolves. A slot may take the **Flex** marker instead (Overtime, see page 2).
2. **SHIT HAPPENS** *(week 2 on)* - draw **2 Events**, read them out. Nothing resolves yet.
3. **ADAPT** - cancel Events by paying each one's **Adaptability cost** (1, 2 or 3) in adapt tokens, or play a Hero. A Habit takes 1 off the cost (minimum 0: a cost-1 Event is free).
4. **SURVIVING EVENTS HAPPEN** - resolve every Event nobody cancelled.
5. **THE WEEK RUNS** - resolve the five cards in **any order**. The week happened at once.
6. **CLOSE** - **bank** finished features (lift any lock) → **walk the Ledger**, at most one step per track → add this week's **adapt tokens** to the pool (Workshop, Demo, Reflect; cap 6).
7. **MOTIVATION** - the **grind**. One net number per character: **−1** for the grind, ±1 per Event category your Torso is hit by or immune to, **+1** if your Need was met. Apply it, **then** anyone on 0 **quits** and everyone still in the team loses 1 Motivation for each quitter. This is the only moment a quit is checked. Move the week marker.

WEEK 1 IS ONLY STEPS 1, 5, 6 AND 7. Lay five cards from **Work, Engagement, Celebrate, Workshop, Plan**, resolve them, bank anything finished, take the grind. No Events, no Ledger, no Needs yet. *A week is five days and you choose them - that is the entire idea.*

WHAT OPENS, AND WHEN

WEEK	WHAT TURNS UP
1	The week. Work, Engagement, Celebrate, Workshop, Plan. **Combos** are open from the start: two named triggers in the same week pay a small bonus (one combo a week).
2	**THE TEAM** turns over: Trust, Capability, Shared Practice, Standing, Capital, Needs, the adapt pool (starts at 3 tokens), Shit Happens and Adapt. The Demo card opens, with Learn, Teach and Reflect.
3	**THE DEVELOPMENT** (Learn/Teach payoff), Flex and Overtime. No new cards.
4	Nothing new. Play everything you have met.
5	Nothing new. Play everything you have met.
6–7	Nothing new. The project ends when week 7 closes.

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THE ACTIVITIES · ONE CARD = ONE DAY

The cards belong to the team. Nothing here is "may": if a number is not listed, nothing happens.

CARD	EXACT EFFECT
Work	**+1** to one feature's Work counter (Capability changes it; never below 0). Not on a feature whose dependency is not yet banked.
Plan	Pick a feature: every Work card on it this week gives **+1 extra**. High complexity: also next week. Nothing on Low features. Does nothing at Shared Practice 1 or less (so nothing in week 1).
Engagement	**+1 Trust.** One a week.
Workshop	The meeting nobody wants. **Every character pays 1 Motivation**; the team gets **+3 adapt tokens** at the close, spendable from next week. Nothing if anyone is on 1. One way only. One card, open from week 1.
Reflect	One a week at most. Needs **Trust 3+**. +1 adapt token. Look back at **last week**: a feature was banked (◎), you adapted to 2 Events (↝), or a Hero or a token played / an Event cost Trust, Capability or Shared Practice (↻)? Then also **+1 Shared Practice**, **+1 Motivation to everyone on 3 or less**, and the team fills the matching Team Reflexivity well (the token still goes to the pool).
Learn	Every character marks a free square **left or right** of one they cover, in their own row (up to five new squares). Then tile the Zone for each. No Capital.
Teach	Up to **two** teachers; each lets one other character mark a square **someone already covers**, **up, down, left, right or diagonally** of one the teacher covers, any row. Then flip that tile to stacked. **Both teachers +1 Capital.** Dead while Trust is 1 or less.
Demo	Needs Capital at or above the team average. The team names one character: **+1 Capital and +1 Motivation**, and the team gets **+1 adapt token**.
Celebrate	**+1 Motivation to everyone on 3 or less** - but only if there is something to celebrate: a feature was banked this week, or every Event was cancelled. Nothing if you also celebrated last week.
Onboarding	Only when a seat is empty. The team lays it, it costs the day, and a replacement joins at once (Motivation 5, Capital 0). One a week. All quitting rules are on the card.

Overtime. A **sixth** card the team may lay: one character pays **1 Motivation** and takes the Flex marker, and the team owes that day back later. Unrepaid Flex costs **2** at scoring. Only one Flex marker at a time.

Take One For The Team. Only a **Dependable** character can play it: pay **2 Motivation** for **+1 Trust** and **+1 Capital**, at once, from week 1. Not a card. Once a week, and not in a week Engagement already raised Trust.

Take the blame (Own It). A character with the Own It instinct can take the blame for an Event nobody cancelled, at the cost of **1 Motivation**: the team gains **+1 Trust** at once. It uses the week's one Trust step.

NEEDS · FROM WEEK 2

At step 7 you get **+1 Motivation** if your Torso's Need was met this week. Autonomy, Hierarchy and Community also count as met while the team holds their Habit.

Autonomy	At most 1 Event landed on the team.
Hierarchy	The team played a Teach, Learn or Workshop.
Community	The team spent an Engagement or a Reflect, or holds Psychological Safety and no Management or People Event

THE ZONE · TWO THINGS EVERY TIME

Whenever someone **Learns** or is **Taught**, do two things, in this order:

1. **`Mark it on the SPECIMEN`** - a counter on that character's own SKILLS grid. The coloured face means "new this week": it cannot be taught until the week closes.
2. **`Cover it on THE ZONE`** - no tile there? Put one down. A tile already there? **`Flip it.`**

 **one dot** - one of you covers this square

 **two dots** - stacked: two or more cover it

Counters are never taken off and tiles never flip back. The Ledger reads the Zone only at the moment a tile goes down or flips. Your sheet is the record of *what I can do*; the Zone is the team's picture of the same squares. Everyone can read everyone's sheet.

THE LEDGER READS THE ZONE	
Capability +1	A whole **row or column** of the Zone now has a tile on every square (either face).
Shared Practice +1	A tile **flips to its stacked face** - two of you now cover the same square.
Cross-Trained	The first time your own SKILLS grid has squares in a **2nd row**: **+1 Capability** for the team, once each.

THE LEDGER AND MOTIVATION

- **Trust, Capability, Shared Practice** - coins on THE TEAM (scale 0–5), one step a week each. A coin that reaches its ring turns into a **Habit**: it makes one Event category cheaper to cancel, and satisfies a Need.
- **Adaptability** is a shared pile of tokens (cap 6). Spend them in step 3.
- **Capital** is earned, never given: a Demo, a Teach, a strength that visibly worked, Take One For The Team. Rich in Capital = standing in the team.
- **Motivation** is personal. The grind takes 1 every week; Celebrate and a met Need give it back. **At 0 you quit**: the team scores −40, everyone still in the team loses 1 Motivation, and the seat stays empty until the team lays Onboarding (it costs a day).